

Sultant Of Oman
Ministry of Health
Royal Hospital



سلطنة عمان
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المستشفى السلطاني

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Ministry of Health
The Royal Hospital
Department of Pharmacy

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Title: Brought-In-Medication (BIM) Policy

Patient Brought In Medications

1. Purpose

Brought in medications (BIM) refers to patients that bring their home medications with them during admission. The purpose of this policy is to establish guidelines for the identification and documentation of medication brought into the hospital by the patient.

2. Policy Statement

The use of brought in medications is discouraged within our setting. It may be used in certain circumstances only after thorough assessment and appropriate documentation. If BIM are to be administered to the patient the following must be considered:

1. An order must be written by the prescriber. The order must specify the medication, dose, frequency, indication and route.
2. All ordered medication that has been brought in must be assessed by a pharmacist.

3. Scope

This policy covers all patients at the Royal Hospital that bring their own medications from home. It excludes patients that want to administer their own medications during their hospital stay.

4. Applicability

This policy and procedure applies to all Royal Hospital staff, members of the medical team, including physicians, nurses, and pharmacy staff.

Royal Hospital managers will demonstrate commitment to safety of all patients by ensuring that all clients with brought in medications have their medications assessed and evaluated.

In certain circumstances when it is advisable to use brought in medications for selected patients, it is the physicians responsibility to ensure that appropriate documentation in the patient chart are made.

The Nursing department is responsible to assess the patient's brought in medications and liaise with the pharmacy staff for any concerns and further decisions on whether to use brought in medications by the patient or to return it back to the pharmacy for appropriate disposal. Please refer to the chart below for further information. The Pharmacy department is responsible to evaluate the medications and act accordingly.

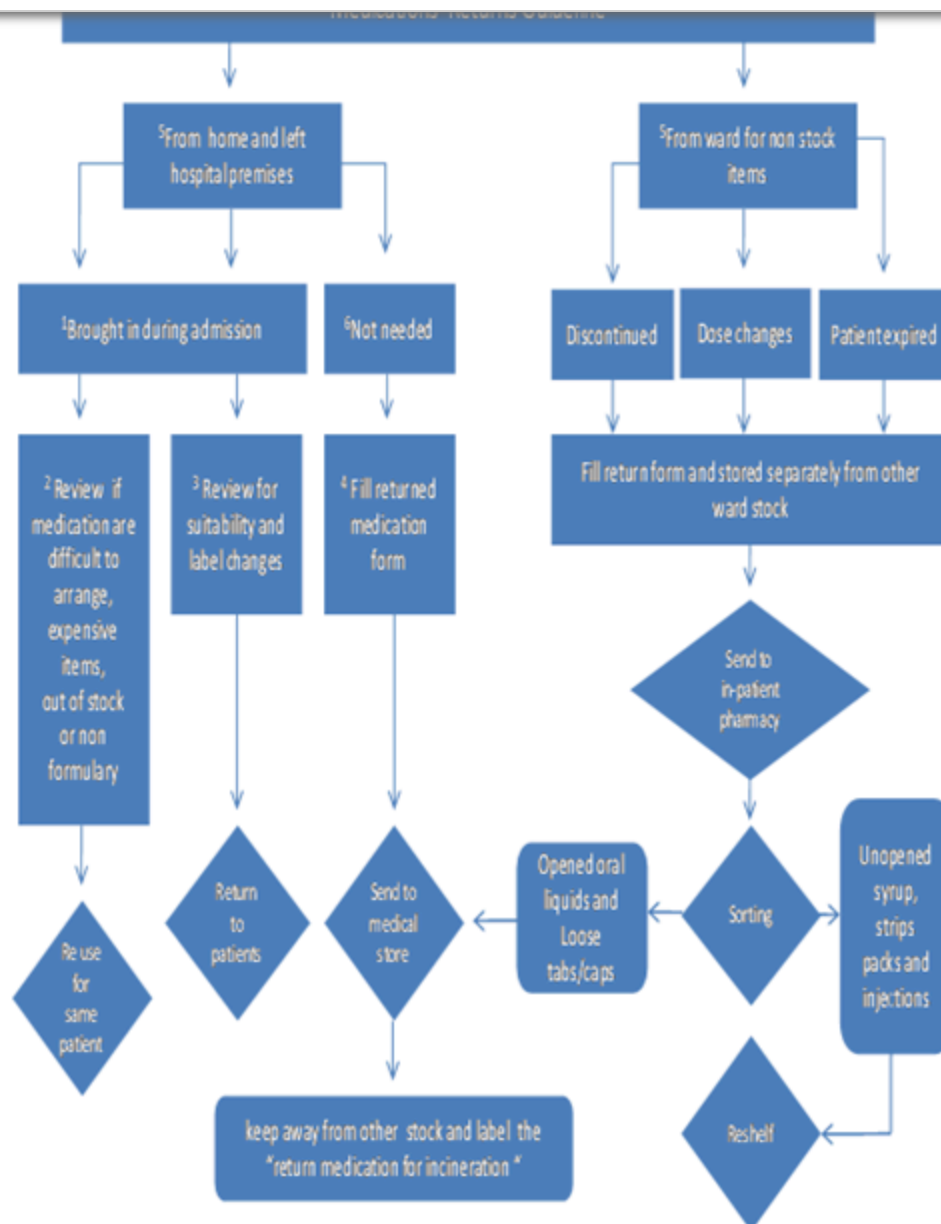
5. Principles

The Nursing department and the In-patient pharmacy services at the Royal Hospital will demonstrate commitment to safety of all patients by ensuring that processes are in place to identify and manage brought in medications in accordance with this policy to minimize any potential harm that may be caused.

6. Procedure

- All medications brought in during admission should be returned to the patient upon discharge whenever possible.
- Nursing staff carrying out the admission procedure should determine whether the patient has brought any medication with him/her from home.
- Brought in medications may be used by healthcare professionals to determine medication history and/or used for medication reconciliation.
- The use of a patient's own medications is **discouraged**. A patients own medication may **be used only** if
 - The equivalent formulary drug is not acceptable. Contact pharmacy if an order is requested for a non-formulary medication. (or not found in the Al-shifaa prescribing module).
 - The medication is not available and cannot be purchased in an appropriate time frame.
- If brought in medications is **to be used** during admission, prescribers must ensure that there is a clear order in the patients chart, and make it clear that this is a patient's own medication.
- Medications brought into the hospital which will **not be used** during the patients admission should:
 - Be placed in a bag labeled with the patients name and the name of the ward that the patient is admitted in.
 - The labeled medications will be stored in the nursing unit in a secure place.
- The medications will be returned to the patient upon discharge. Nursing staff must liaise with inpatient pharmacy to ensure any changes in the medication instructions are updated and communicated to the patient.
- In the event that medications are not returned to the patient upon discharge, they should be forwarded to the inpatient pharmacy. If medications are not retrieved by the patient from the inpatient pharmacy within 2 weeks of discharge, they will be discarded.
- Medications of deceased patients must be returned for the pharmacy for appropriate disposal.

Please refer to the chart below for further information.



1. Brought in medication during admission should be encouraged to facilitate medication history and reconciliation.
2. Medication can be reused by patient under special conditions if necessary after gaining approval from the pharmacist. Documentation in patient chart as BIM must be clear and visible.
3. Patient's medications should be returned back to patients only after confirming label changes and suitability of use by a pharmacist.
4. Brought in medication not needed by patients should not be reused for other patients. Attach the return form with the medication, and return it to the inpatient pharmacy for disposal.
5. Pharmacy and nursing staff must review expiry date.

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